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Professor Martinez

Sprint Review and Retrospective

Throughout the SNHU Travel project, I took on the various roles of Product Owner, Tester, Scrum Master, and Developer. As the Product Owner, I created user stories and acceptance criteria to ensure that the customer needs were clearly translated. As the Tester, I used the information provided by the Product Owner to create test cases and identify any missing information, such as what the system should do if invalid information is entered. As the Scrum Master, I focused on orchestrating Scrum events and how they could help my team stay organized and communicate effectively. My experience as a Developer required me to alter an existing Java slideshow when the Product Owner changed the project's focus to detox/wellness travel. Now although I did not work with an actual team, being able to roleplay in each role has helped me understand the responsibilities of each position and how the overall development process works.

The Scrum-Agile approach helped user stories come to completion by breaking the project into smaller bits that could be easily understood, developed, and tested. The user stories provided the team with a description of what the customer needed, while the acceptance criteria gave more specific conditions for determining whether each point was satisfied (International Software Testing Qualifications Board [ISTQB], 2024). While roleplaying as the Tester, I utilized the user stories to create test cases for each story rather than guessing what should be

tested. This process helped illustrate how requirements, development, and testing are related throughout the software development life cycle because each stage is built on top of the other.

One of the clearest examples we have of Agile's flexibility occurred when SNHU Travel changed the focus of the platform to detox/wellness travel. Instead of starting over from scratch and discarding the team's work, the Product Owner efficiently explained the new priority and helped each member accurately reprioritize their current work. As the Developer, I was able to change the images and existing destinations on the slideshow with content related to wellness travel while leaving the existing slideshow functionality intact. This experience showed me just how flexible Agile can be when a team needs to respond to changing requirements.

Communication was important throughout the SNHU Travel project because each team member depended on the others for clear requirements and information to complete their individual work. For example, when I was roleplaying as the Tester, I realized I needed more details to write accurate test cases, so I sent this email:

To: Product Owner

Subject: Questions Regarding User Stories

Hi Product Owner,

I am working on creating the test cases for the SNHU Travel user stories and have a few questions regarding some of the requirements. Could you please clarify what should happen if a user enters an invalid travel date or searches for a flight that is unavailable or does not exist? I would also like to know if there are any specific error messages or restrictions that I should consider when creating the test cases. Please let me know if there is anything that I missed. Thank you for all your help.

Best, Product Tester

Later, when the project shifted its focus toward wellness travel, I was acting as the Developer. I needed to know exactly what was changing so I did not waste time working on the wrong features, so I sent this email:

To: Product Owner and Tester

Subject: Clarification and Information Needed for Wellness Travel Updates

Hi Product Owner and Tester,

I am ready to get started on updating the SNHU Travel slideshow based on our new focus on detox and wellness travel, but I had a few quick questions on some items before I move forward. Could you please confirm which existing features or user stories should be updated or deprioritized? If you could also provide any specific requirements for the new travel content? I would also like to know if there are any test cases that need to be updated to reflect these changes and whether there are any new requirements that should be considered in testing. Thank you both for all your help!

Best, Developer

Both examples were effective because they did not just broadly ask for help. They identified specific missing information, such as invalid date errors or updated test priorities. This made it easier for the team to collaborate, clear up misunderstandings, and get me the exact answers I needed to keep the development process moving.

There are several organizational tools and Scrum practices that could help a Scrum team manage its work, including the Product Backlog, user stories, acceptance criteria, and test cases.

The Product Backlog helps keep everything organized by providing a centralized location for prioritizing work, while user stories and acceptance criteria give the development and testing work clear requirements to follow. Scrum events such as Sprint Planning, Daily Scrums, Sprint Reviews, and Sprint Retrospectives provide the team an opportunity to openly communicate and collaborate by discussing individual progress, identifying problems, reviewing completed work, and determining how the team can improve (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020). A project management tool such as Jira can make these practices more effective by making it easier for the team to track user stories, assign work, monitor progress, and see which items are completed or still in progress.

The SNHU Travel project demonstrated the many advantages to using an Agile approach. One major advantage was the flexibility of this methodology; the team was able to respond to the change toward detox/wellness travel by slightly altering their current work instead of starting from scratch. Agile also provided an easy and efficient way to organize requirements, prioritize work, and receive feedback. While great, Agile does have its disadvantages, such as requiring constant communication which can make it more difficult to plan far in advance, especially when requirements can change. For projects like the SNHU Travel, the Agile approach is probably one of the best as travel applications can benefit from customer feedback, changing requirements and being able to reprioritize work without losing all the progress the team has already made.

The SNHU Travel project showed me first-hand how the different stages of the software development life cycle work together within the Agile Methodology. Being able to take on each role within a Scrum team has given me a better understanding of how requirements are created, developed, tested, reviewed, and changed as a project progresses. I most importantly learned that successfully developing a product is not as simple as black and white, but also maintaining clear

requirements, communication, organization, and the ability to respond to change. Based on my experience throughout this project, I believe Scrum-Agile can provide organizations such as ChadaTech a strong development approach if their goal is to become more adaptable and responsive to their customers.

References

International Software Testing Qualifications Board. (2024). *Certified Tester Foundation Level syllabus v4.0.1*. https://istqb.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/11/ISTQB_CTFL_Syllabus_v4.0.1.pdf

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